listened to open borders advocates in 2015'. He then goes even further in his lambasting of Germany with the following words: 'if all of Europe would have sent weapons to Ukraine on the same scale and at the same pace that Germany does – the war would have ended long ago. It would have ended with Russia's absolute victory. And Europe would be on the eve of another war.' (Relations with Germany received another blow a couple of months later, when Polish government sent to Berlin a formal request for World War II reparations valued at 1.3 trillion EUR.)

Morawiecki then turns to EU values, repeating the argument about freedom and equality, but applying this to financial matters, targeting Germany yet again, which traditionally held a positive balance of foreign trade: 'The adoption of a common currency does not guarantee sustainable and harmonious development. In fact, the euro introduces mechanisms of mutual rivalry, which can be seen, for example, in the permanent export surplus of some countries, which counteract the appreciation of their own currency by maintaining economic stagnation in others. In such a system, equal opportunities remain only on paper.' In his eyes, '[t]hese deficits make the European Union particularly vulnerable and weak when confronted with Russian imperialism'.

And although Poland is one of the biggest EU member states, the Polish Prime Minister tries to appeal to smaller member states by saying that in the EU of today 'the rights, interests or needs of medium-sized and small states are losing out when confronted with the largest states' and 'European solidarity is becoming an empty concept'. Other Central European countries may agree on this, though they would not necessarily subscribe to all that the Polish Prime Minister had to say.

In short, 'the European Union order does not protect us enough from external imperialism. The EU's institution and actions, while not being free from the temptation to dominate the weaker, remain exposed to the infiltration of Russian imperialism.' So the EU must first help Ukraine in her struggle, but it 'must also defeat the threat of imperialism within the EU. We need a profound reform that would bring back the common good and equality to the top of the EU's principles.'

And here he touches upon the (future) architecture of the Union, where we need a 'change of optics – it is the member-states, and not the EU institutions, that must decide about the directions and priorities of the EU's